

1. Who are Charles Hurst and where do they operate?

Charles Hurst is Northern Ireland's largest new and used car, van and motorcycle dealer group, with showrooms across locations such as Belfast, Newtownabbey, Lisburn, Portadown, Newtownards and Dundonald. The business also has a presence in Dublin and serves both private and business customers.

2. When was Charles Hurst founded?

The Charles Hurst Group traces its history back to 1911 and has grown from a single operation into Northern Ireland's leading motor group. Over more than a century, it has built a reputation for choice, value and strong customer service in vehicle sales and aftercare.

3. What types of vehicles does Charles Hurst sell?

Charles Hurst offers a broad portfolio of vehicles, including new and used cars, vans and motorcycles. They represent many well-known manufacturers, from premium marques such as Ferrari, Maserati and Aston Martin to mainstream brands like Kia, Hyundai, Nissan and Vauxhall.

4. What services does Charles Hurst provide beyond vehicle sales?

In addition to selling vehicles, Charles Hurst provides aftersales services such as servicing, MOTs, accident repair, bodyshop work, parts and accessories. This means customers can buy, maintain and repair their vehicles within the same group, often at the same location.

5. What does the 'Customers for Life' philosophy mean?

Charles Hurst describes a 'Customers for Life' approach, aiming to support motorists at every stage of their driving journey. From a first car purchase to family vehicles and later upgrades, the group wants to offer consistent service, trustworthy advice and long-term aftercare so that customers keep returning.

6. What locations form the main Charles Hurst hub?

The group is headquartered on Boucher Road in Belfast on a large multi-franchise automotive site, sometimes described as one of the biggest automotive retail parks in Europe. From this hub, and other regional sites, Charles Hurst offers showrooms, service facilities and specialist brand centres.

7. What is special about Charles Hurst's electric and hybrid offering?

Charles Hurst positions itself as an expert in electric and hybrid vehicles in Northern Ireland, with a wide selection of EVs and hybrids from brands such as Toyota, Lexus, Renault, Nissan, Jaguar and Land Rover. They encourage customers to visit their sites to explore models, ask questions about charging and take extended test drives.

8. Can I spend time on-site to learn more about EVs and hybrids?

Yes. Their EV and Hybrid FAQs invite customers to spend time at key locations, such as their Boucher Road retail site, to view multiple electric and hybrid vehicles in one place. Staff can explain charging options, home-installation considerations and real-world driving ranges in detail.

9. Does Charles Hurst offer apprenticeships?

Charles Hurst runs structured apprenticeship programmes across various departments, including vehicle technicians, service advisors and administrative roles. Apprentices gain hands-on experience in working dealerships and often receive brand-specific training from manufacturer partners.

10. How long does a typical apprenticeship last at Charles Hurst?

A typical technical apprenticeship at Charles Hurst lasts several years, allowing apprentices to build skills gradually while working towards recognised qualifications. Over this period, they receive mentoring, on-the-job training and exposure to modern diagnostic equipment and evolving automotive technology.

11. Does Charles Hurst provide work-experience placements for students?

Yes. The company offers work-experience placements, often in sales, administration or workshop environments. Students can observe day-to-day operations, assist under supervision and gain a better understanding of whether a career in the motor trade suits their interests and skills.

12. Will I have a mentor if I take a work-experience placement?

Work-experience candidates are typically assigned a mentor or supervisor who explains tasks, answers questions and ensures that the placement is structured and safe. This support helps young people make the most of their time in the business while contributing in a meaningful but managed way.

13. What employee benefits does Charles Hurst advertise?

Charles Hurst lists various staff benefits, such as discounts on new and used vehicles, reduced rates on service and repairs, favourable rental offers, pension schemes and ongoing learning and development. These benefits are designed to reward commitment and encourage long-term careers within the group.

14. How many brands does Charles Hurst represent?

Different sources mention that Charles Hurst represents more than 20–30 vehicle manufacturers across its sites. This gives customers access to a wide choice of makes and models, from

everyday cars and vans to prestige and performance vehicles, all within one overarching group.

15. How does Charles Hurst support sustainability and future technologies?

Charles Hurst has publicly discussed plans to grow its electric-vehicle offering and to work towards more sustainable operations, including reducing emissions across its sites. By investing in EV infrastructure and training, the group aims to remain a key player as the market shifts towards low■emission mobility.

16. Does Charles Hurst cater to both private and business customers?

Yes. Charles Hurst serves individual motorists looking for a personal car as well as business and fleet customers requiring multiple vehicles, vans or specialist models. Their teams can advise on funding options, tax implications and fleet support packages for commercial clients.

17. Are there specialist or prestige divisions within Charles Hurst?

Charles Hurst operates specialist divisions for high-end brands such as Ferrari, Maserati, Bentley and Aston Martin, particularly within its Belfast operations. These centres offer bespoke customer experiences, tailored handovers and trained staff who understand the expectations of premium and performance-car buyers.

18. How can I contact Charles Hurst about sales or service?

Customers can contact Charles Hurst through individual dealership phone numbers and enquiry forms listed on the group's website. Separate contact details are often provided for sales, servicing, parts and complaints, helping callers reach the right team quickly.

19. What kind of recognition has Charles Hurst received?

Over the years, Charles Hurst has received multiple industry awards in Northern Ireland, recognising its performance in customer service, sales and brand representation. Such awards help underline its position as a leading automotive retailer in the region.

20. Can I get accident repair and bodyshop services through Charles Hurst?

Yes. In addition to standard servicing, Charles Hurst operates or partners with bodyshop and accident-repair facilities that can handle anything from minor cosmetic damage to major collision repairs. They aim to restore vehicles to a high standard using appropriate methods and parts, often working in coordination with insurers.